

Athena's Little Owl

The sunlit hills of Greece roll down to a bright blue sea, dotted with olive groves, white marble columns, and little towns where everyone knows your name. High above, hidden in the clouds of Mount Olympus, the gods watch over the world, and the hills are full of wonders: riddling sphinxes, kindly centaurs, shy satyrs, and nymphs who sing by the springs. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who keeps a cool head, asks good questions, and stands by a friend. The grandest deeds are done by being clever and brave and kind. Even a fearsome guardian, met with courage and a fair word, often turns out to be lonelier than it is wicked.



Athena's Little Owl

Read aloud, slowly and warmly. Stop often to let the children answer. There are no wrong answers here, only kind new ideas to try.

Before you begin

One grey, misty morning a tiny owl came tumbling out of the fog and landed, all ruffled, in the middle of the Olive Town. Her name is Glaux, and she belongs to wise Athena, high on the hill of white marble. But the fog is thick, and poor Glaux cannot find her way home.

Old Daphne, who keeps the olive grove, calls you to her. "You two have sharp eyes and kind hearts," she says. "Will you help little Glaux find her way back up to Athena?"

She tucks a soft scarf around the owl and smiles. "Up here we do not help by being the biggest or the fastest. We help by being clever, brave, and kind."

What is your hero name? Are you a hero of Wits, of Courage, or of Heart?

Stop 1: The Foggy Square



Glaux sits in the middle of the square, very small and very scared. Her feathers are puffed up. Her big round eyes blink fast. When you step too quickly, she hops away.

How could you help her feel safe? Could you move slowly and speak softly? Could you hold out a steady hand for her to perch on? What do you try?

When you are calm and gentle, Glaux stops trembling. She hops onto your hand and gives a happy little hoot. Now she trusts you.

Stop 2: The Whispering Paths



At the edge of town, three little paths climb up into the mist. They all look the same. Only one leads to Athena's temple.

A goat-legged satyr peeks over a wall. It is Bramble, who loves a traveller and a good joke. He hums and tips his head, ready to help if you ask nicely.

How will you choose the right path? Look closely. Glaux dropped soft grey feathers as she fell. Could you follow them back up? Could you ask Bramble for a hint?

When you follow the trail of feathers, or ask kind Bramble, you find the right path and climb up through the mist together.

Stop 3: The High Perch



At the top stands a little marble temple. High up is Glaux's cosy perch, but she is tired and the last of the fog still hides it. She is afraid to fly up alone.

This is not about being strong. How could you help her up? Could you lift a steady branch like a bridge? Could you cheer her on so she feels brave? What do you do?

When you help her with kindness, Glaux flutters up to her perch and snuggles down, safe and warm at last.

Glaux Comes Home



As the little owl settles, two calm grey eyes open in the temple. It is Athena, goddess of good ideas, and she is smiling at you.

The morning fog melts away. Sunlight pours over the Olive Town below, warm and golden. Glaux hoots a thank-you from her perch.

You did it together. You were clever, you were brave, and most of all, you were kind. Well done, heroes.

My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

I am a hero of

My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



My magics



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can

What I carry

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.

Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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